

SOP-MACH-1200: Machine Guarding Requirements

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs guarding of point-of-operation, rotating, and in-running nip point hazards on production and shop machinery.

Section 2. Guard Requirement

Clause 2.1 — Any machine part, function, or process that may cause injury shall be guarded if the point of operation is not otherwise protected by location or distance.

Clause 2.2 — A fixed guard is required wherever the hazard is constant and access is not needed during normal operation; an interlocked guard is required wherever access is needed for changeover or clearing jams.

Section 3. Interlock Function

Clause 3.1 — An interlocked guard shall stop hazardous motion within the machine's rated stopping time when opened, verified at commissioning and after any guard maintenance.

Clause 3.3 — Defeating, bypassing, or removing an interlock to increase production rate is prohibited under any circumstance; a machine requiring guard defeat to function shall be taken out of service pending engineering correction.

Section 4. Lockout Interface

Clause 4.1 — Guard removal for maintenance requires lockout/tagout per SOP-LOTO-400 in addition to this procedure — an open interlocked guard alone is not an isolation method.

Section 5. Inspection

Clause 5.1 — Machine guards shall be inspected for integrity at each shift change by the operator, and formally inspected quarterly by maintenance.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Guard inspection records and interlock function tests are filed to the Mechanical Maintenance File and retained for 3 years.